

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 4-6

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

W	H	E	R	E
W	H	I	L	E

Ladder 2

G	R	A	C	E
T	H	I	N	G

Ladder 3

B	L	A	N	K
C	H	E	C	K

Ladder 4

S	H	A	R	K
S	P	O	K	E

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

W	H	E	R	E
T	H	E	R	E
T	H	E	S	E
T	H	O	S	E
W	H	O	S	E
W	H	O	L	E
W	H	I	L	E

Ladder 2

G	R	A	C	E
T	R	A	C	E
T	R	A	C	K
T	R	I	C	K
T	H	I	C	K
T	H	I	N	K
T	H	I	N	G

Ladder 3

B	L	A	N	K
B	L	A	C	K
B	L	O	C	K
C	L	O	C	K
C	L	I	C	K
C	H	I	C	K
C	H	E	C	K

Ladder 4

S	H	A	R	K
S	H	A	R	E
S	P	A	R	E
S	P	A	C	E
S	P	I	C	E
S	P	I	K	E
S	P	O	K	E